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Politics - Who's running in Assembly special elections locally?

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A list of candidates dominated by Democrats and more women than usual was certified by staff officials late Wednesday for the special elections April 3 in three open California Assembly seats in the Los Angeles area.

Here's how the candidates will be listed, with their parties and official ballot designations. Order was determined randomly.

Assembly District 39

In the northeast San Fernando Valley seat left vacant when Raul Bocanegra resigned in November amid sexual-harassment allegations, six candidates qualified for the ballot: Luz Rivas (Democrat), educator/commissioner; Patrea Patrick (D), documentary producer/author; Ricardo Benitez (Republican), business owner; Yolie Anguiano (D), public administrator; Antonio Sanchez (D), Workforce Development director, and Patty Lopez (D), community volunteer.

Assembly District 45

In the west San Fernando Valley, eight candidates will appear on the ballot to replace Matt Dababneh, who resigned in December after being accused of sexual misconduct: Justin Clark (R), who'll run without a ballot designation; Tricia Robbins Kasson (D), Economic Development director; Jesse Gabriel (D), constitutional rights attorney; Ankur Patel (D), school community coordinator; Daniel Brin (D), Neighborhood Coun

cil president; Jeff Bornstein (D), small-business owner; Ray Bishop (D), small-business owner, and Dennis Zine (no party), no ballot designation. Zine announced Monday he's out of the race, but his name remains on the ballot.

Assembly District 54

Covering parts of Los Angeles, including the Westside, this district is without a representative since Sebastian Ridley-Thomas resigned in December, citing health issues. There are four candidates: Glen Ratliff (R), small-business owner; Grayson Pangilinan (D), green energy entrepreneur; Tepring Piquado (D), educator/scientist, and Sydney Kamlager (D), trustee, Los Angeles Community College District.

In each district, unless a candidate gets an outright majority of the votes, the top two will advance to a runoff June 5, which also is the day of the primary for the Nov. 6 election for the next two-year term. Special-election winners will serve until Dec. 3.

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